

are signed up for online, or advertisements. The occasional spam email, too. A step up from that are the emails you do want to get but don't always require a lot of attention: Google news alerts etc. And then there's real important email. These emails may require research and thought, and in many cases deserve responses. Whatever kinds of email you get, one strategy for dealing with the volume, especially at the start of each day, is to triage your email, or go through the list and apply actions to blocks of email in bulk. And this is a task that good mobile email solutions, including Windows Phone's Mail, excel at.

To triage your email in Windows Phone, launch the Mail app. It will appear in the All view, as always. First, just delete the unwanted mail. To do so efficiently, tap the Select button in the Application Bar; it resembles a list of checked items and is the third of the four available buttons. This changes the view a bit, adding a selection box next to each email message header. Now, scroll down the list and locate any messages you can safely delete. Tap the selection box next to each of the messages. When you're done, you can apply a number of actions to those messages as a group, but of course in this first pass the goal is to permanently delete the unwanted mail. So tap the Delete button in the Application Bar. Now all those messages are gone.

Hopefully, this has dramatically pruned your list of unread e-mail. The next thing you do is read, then file those messages you want to save but don't need to act on. Just tap the Move button instead of Delete when you're ready, and then select a folder to which to move those messages in the pop-up folder list that appears. (This list will vary from e-mail account to e-mail account, since each e-mail account and service uses a slightly different folder management structure, and of course, you may have created your own folders as well.)

Actions you can apply to multiple messages include:

- ▶ **Delete:** This permanently deletes the selected message(s) as noted previously.
- ▶ **Move:** This permanently moves the selected message(s) from the inbox to whatever folder you specify.
- ▶ **Mark as read:** This makes it appear as if the selected message(s) are read (even if they were never read).
- ▶ **Mark as unread:** This makes it appear as if the selected message(s) are unread (even if they were actually read).
- ▶ **Set flag:** This marks the selected message(s) as flagged.